

Rung and question	A pass lets you claim	A failure looks like	Your study needs
LEVEL 4 Structural fidelity Do the items form the same scale as in people, in every group?	The total can be scored as one score and compared across groups.	The total stops measuring one thing, or measures it differently by group.	A multi-item scale, individual human answers and enough personas per group.
LEVEL 3 Population calibration Is each group's level right?	A group's simulated level (mean, prevalence, share agreeing) can stand in for the real one.	The whole sample is shifted, or a right mean hides a wrong prevalence.	Human levels for the same groups, and weights to match the persona mix.
LEVEL 2 Subgroup fidelity Are the gaps between groups the right size and direction?	Group differences can be read from the sample: an income gradient, a partisan gap.	A gap is exaggerated, shrunk, erased or reversed.	A human reference that measures the gap precisely, for groups the personas match.
LEVEL 1 Individual coherence Could a real person give this answer, and do answers vary as much as people's?	Single draws can serve as individual cases: vignettes, test items, synthetic respondents.	Every persona answers alike, or answer patterns are too regular to be human.	A multi-item scale and individual human answers on it.
GATE Regeneration stability Is a persona's score stable enough to read?	The average of k draws can be read as the model's answer for that persona.	Answers change from draw to draw, so a single draw is mostly noise.	Repeated draws of each persona. Any outcome.